



**ST. PATRICK'S BALLYPHILIP
TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME
Sunday 6th September 2026**



**Fr Feargal McGrady PP Tel: 028 427 28234 Web: www.portaferryparish.com
Email: portaferry@downandconnor.org Livestream: www.churchmedia.tv
Parish Office: 028 427 28373, Monday – Friday 9.00am – 1.00pm**

Parish Bereavement Ministry

This group offers support for anyone experiencing bereavement. If you would like to talk to a member please Telephone: 07564293692

**ST PATRICK'S COMMUNITY CENTRE CONTACTS:
MADELINE DYNES 07999945936 & JAMES MAGEE 07542530006
During Business Hours**

	St Patrick's Portaferry	St Cooley's Oratory	St Patrick's Ballygalget
Sunday 6 th September TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME	11am Mass		9.30am Mass
Monday 7 th September		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Novena Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Tuesday 8 th September Nativity of Mary			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Wednesday 9 th September St Ciaran		7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Thursday 10 th September St Peter Claver			9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass
Friday 11 th September	9.00am Rosary 9.30am Mass	Eucharistic Adoration 10.00am – 6.00pm	7.00pm Rosary 7.30pm Mass
Saturday 12 th September The Holy Name of Mary St Ailbe	5.45pm Adoration 6.30pm Vigil Mass		5.00pm Vigil Mass

Our prayers are requested for the happy repose of the soul of Bernadette Cooper, recently deceased and for the following whose anniversaries occur around this time:

Annie Murray, William Breen, Nancy McHenry, Seamus Smyth, Patsy Andrews, Harry Andrews, Nora McAlister, Margaret Craig, Letitia McVeigh, Catherine Morrin, Sarah McCormick, Annita Crawford, Ena Quinn, Ronan & Muriel Curran, Bobby Adair (Senior), John Savage.

May their souls and the souls of all the faithful departed, rest in peace, Amen.

FIRST SATURDAY PRAYERS: will continue Saturday 5th September at 9.30am in St. Cooley's Oratory. As requested by Our Lady at Fatima, the Rosary and Consecration Prayer will be recited.

MASS INTENTIONS

Saturday 5th September: **Annie Murray, William Breen, Bridie Savage**
Sunday 6th September: **Eamon Fitzsimmons (Months Mind), Nancy McHenry**
Monday 7th September: **Seamus Smyth**
Saturday 12th September: **Paddy Smyth, Dominic Pucci**
Sunday 13th September: **Oliver Lynch**

HARVEST SERVICE in Portaferry Methodist Church, Sunday 27th September at 7pm, Rev Alan Wardlow, the Past President of the Methodist Church in Ireland will lead the service alongside other local church leaders. A joint churches choir will help us in our music as we thank God for his goodness to us. Light refreshments provided after the service. Food or financial gifts will be welcome but must be shelf stable goods that will be donated to the local Food Bank. These can be brought to the church Sat morning 26th at 09:30-10:30am or brought on Sunday evening to the service.



If you are having difficulties with your expenses ring our confidential telephone: 07508 549701. We can help.
Donations for the month of August came to £2,205.00.
Thank you for your support and generosity.

Weekly Offering: £1,405.00 (Last week's Weekly collection was £1,441.00)
Thank you for your continued support and generosity.



PORTAFERRY AND BALLYGALGET BAPTISM MINISTRY

Baptism Information sessions will begin after Halloween. Dates will depend on Baptisms that are booked via the Parish office.

Parents/ Guardians/ Godparents and Grandparents will be invited to attend. The information sessions will be:

- Short
- Informal
- Explain the rite of Baptism
- Provide refreshments
- Provide a welcome gift for each child.

Over the next few weeks, we will be setting up 'Baptism trees' in St Patrick's Portaferry and St Patrick's Ballygalget beside the Baptismal fonts. The name of each child to be baptised will be hung on the tree as a welcoming gesture from our Parish communities.

May the time of preparation for Baptism be filled with peace, gratitude and the loving presence of God in our families.

The Folk Group returns this Sunday 6 September at 11.00 mass.

We would welcome new members, young (from P6) and anyone else who enjoys music and singing and might like to try out being part of a choir.

Anyone interested in joining us please come along any Sunday and learn as you go.

Contact Bernie Doran on 078 4992 7581 or Lorna Spence on 078 5064 8091.

Notices for the parish bulletin need to be with the parish office by Wednesday 12noon.
Anniversary notices can be left in the anniversary boxes in either church,
(Boxes beside the candle shrines), sent by email, or rang into the office.

St. Patrick's Community Centre, Portaferry
NEW FOR AUTUMN – Week Beginning 7th September

- Mon.** Tea and Chat, Gentle Exercise, Whist, Quiz 11.00am Text 07873284252
Guitar for Improvers 12.30pm Text 07999945936
Ferry Fit 6.45pm
Ferry Fit 7.45pm
- Tues.** Portaferry Crafters (Textiles) 10.30am Text 07999945936
Netball for P5 to Year10. 6.30pm to 7.30pm Text 07542530006
Ceili Dancing 7.15pm Text 07395200128
Ukulele Beginners 6.30pm; Improvers 7.15pm Text 07999945936
- Wed.** Fit 4 ALL 9.30am (Gently Does It) Text 07999945936
Judo 5.00pm Text 07929905310
- Thurs.** Community Centre Singers 10.30am Text 07999945936
Jo Jingles 12.00pm Text 07395200128
The Hive (Arts & Crafts) 12.30pm Text 07999945936
"Painting Portraits" coming soon 7pm. Watch out for details.
Ferry Film Club (Last Thursday in the month) 7.00pm
Family Film "Song of the Sea" 27th August @7.00pm
Ferry Fit 8.00pm
- Fri.** Party Dance 9.30am Text 07999945936
Walking Group 11.00am
- Sat.** Flower Arranging (1st Sat of each month) 12 noon text 07999945936



Next Bingo Sunday 13th September at 3pm in aid of Air Ambulance.

See our Face Book page for further details: [Stpatrickscmmunitycentreportaferry](#) or text the relevant number with your details and the activity which interests you.

To hire any of our six rooms, please text [07542530006](#) or [07999945936](#)

St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit, Portaferry.
Could You Spare an Hour?

As we begin another new school year, St Mary's Primary School & Nursery Unit is seeking volunteers from our parish and wider community to help enrich the lives of our children. Whether you could support reading, maths activities, sports coaching, art, languages, gardening or simply share a skill, hobby or life experience, even a small amount of your time can make a meaningful difference.

If you can spare one hour a week, one hour a month, or help with a particular project, we would love to hear from you.

Contact the school on 028427 28278 or email pgilchrist570@c2kni.net

Share your time. Share your talents. Help our children learn, grow and shine.

BAPTISMS: Portaferry Parish: 2nd & 4th Sunday of the month

Ballygalget Parish: 1st & 3rd Sunday

Please book with the parish office, (**Not the parochial house.**) Portaferry: 02842728373

Mon - Fri 9am - 1pm. Ballygalget: 07398623134 Wed or Fri 9am -1pm.

A copy of your child's Birth Certificate (Long version) is required prior to Baptism date.

BALLYGALGET, PORTAFERRY & ARDKEEN PARISHES

Day Out

FAITH, HERITAGE & COMMUNITY

Explore. Experience. Enjoy Together.



A SHEPHERD'S LIFE AT GLENSHANE COUNTRY FARM
SHEEP SHEARING DEMONSTRATION

Step into the past and experience life on the farm. Watch a live **sheep shearing** demonstration and see working sheepdogs, **hold baby lambs** and more.



THE GORTA EXPERIENCE AT FRIELS

A powerful and moving visitor experience that brings the story of the Great Famine to life.



DINNER AT FRIELS BAR & RESTAURANT, SWATRAGH

Relax and enjoy a delicious **3-course dinner** in the warm and welcoming surroundings of Friels.



TRAVEL IN COMFORT WITH CONNECTIONS IRELAND

- ✓ Modern, luxury coach
- ✓ Air conditioning
- ✓ Spacious seating
- ✓ Friendly, professional driver

PRICE:

£60

PER PERSON
Includes coach travel, all admissions & 3-course dinner

FULLY GUIDED THROUGHOUT THE DAY
Our day out will be fully guided throughout by a professional tour guide accredited by Tour Guides Northern Ireland.

TOUR GUIDES NORTHERN IRELAND

DATE:
THURSDAY
24 SEPTEMBER 2026

DEPARTURE:
LEAVING PORTAFERRY SQUARE AT 9.00 AM SHARP

RETURN:
APPROX. 6.00 PM

WHO CAN JOIN?
Open to everyone in the Parishes of Ballygalget, Portaferry & Ardkeen.

TO SECURE YOUR PLACE CONTACT:
SEAMUS DORRIAN
ON 07813968171

ALL PLACES ALLOCATED ON A FIRST COME FIRST SERVED BASIS.
Don't miss out - book early to avoid disappointment!

Together in Faith. Together in Community.

The Chosen – Season 2 at the Belfast Jesuit Centre

Weekly screenings of *The Chosen: Season 2* will take place each Friday at the Belfast Jesuit Centre. Tea/coffee at **10.45am**, episode at **11.00am**, followed by a reflective Examen and discussion. All are welcome; no registration required.

Episode dates: 4 Sept, 11 Sept, 18 Sept, 25 Sept, 2 Oct, 9 Oct, 16 Oct, 23rd October.

Thinking about becoming Catholic or want to deepen your understanding of the faith?

The Diocesan RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) is a journey of faith, formation, and community for adults who wish to explore the teachings of Jesus Christ and the Catholic Church. It is open to those who are not baptised, those baptised in another Christian tradition, or Catholics who wish to reconnect with their faith.

The 2026–2027 programme begins on Wednesday 23rd September and runs weekly from 6.30–8.00 pm at St Mary's Hall, Chapel Lane, Belfast. Sessions include prayer, teaching, discussion, and time for questions. Spouses, fiancés or friends are welcome to attend alongside participants.

All are welcome, whether you are exploring faith for the first time or returning after some time away.

To register or find out more, please email rcia@downandconnor.org or scan the QR code.



St Colmcille's
Laudato Si' Group
in association with **trócaire**
— invite you to join us for —

Heroes for Humanity

A series of workshops exploring the principles of Catholic Social Teaching through the lives of four remarkable individuals.

	Wednesday 9 September 2026 Saint Oscar Romero
	Wednesday 16 September 2026 Sister Dorothy Stang
	Wednesday 23 September 2026 Dorothy Day
	Wednesday 30 September 2026 Martin Luther King Jr

Each event will be in
St Colmcille's Parish Hall
191a Upper Newtownards Road,
Belfast, BT4 3JB

 Beginning at **7.15 pm**

 Ending with a cuppa around **8.45 pm**

All are welcome! ♥

Beginning Experience – Beginning Experience is a peer ministry to the bereaved, separated and divorced, based within the Family Ministry of the Diocese of Down and Connor. We are offering a support programme over three Saturdays from September through to November and would be most grateful if you could include the following information in your Church Bulletin at your earliest convenience.

The loss of a partner through death, separation or divorce is devastating. Beginning Experience is offering a programme of bereavement support in St Bride's Hall, Derryvolgie Ave., Belfast on three Saturdays (26th September 24th October and 21st November) Booking essential. To find out more contact Marie 07896119669 or email belfastbe@yahoo.com

Bereavement Information Evening especially dedicated to supporting surviving siblings this autumn. As part of our commitment to supporting everyone following the death of a child, we are exploring opportunities to further support the entire family. This event is the first, hopefully of many, of that commitment. This event is open to all parents whose child or children have died, regardless of the age of their child, circumstances of their death, or time since bereavement. We are also opening this Bereavement Information Evening to bereaved adult siblings over 18. This event will take place online on Tuesday 15 September at 7pm.

We are joined by an exceptional panel of local organisations and experts in sibling bereavement. Michelle Hartnett is a senior play therapist, systemic practitioner, and bereavement specialist currently working with LauraLynn, Ireland's Children's Hospice, with over 15 years' experience supporting families through serious illness, grief, and loss. Michelle holds an MSc in Systemic Therapy and an MSc in Bereavement Studies and is a Grief Consultant with Middlesex University. She also holds a postgraduate certificate and diploma in Play Therapy from NUI Galway.

Anna May is founder of The Student Grief Network and Executive Head of Grief Programmes at Kaplan International. She lost her brother as a child and her dad as a young adult and is passionate about improving the support that people get following a bereavement. Anna is also a writer and artist, interested in how creativity can help us explore difficult human experiences and build more connected ways of living.

We are also joined by Childhood Cancer Ireland, Jacinta's Smile, and Rainbows.

In the world of grief and loss, siblings, especially adult siblings, are often called 'forgotten mourners.' Siblings face not only their own loss, but often the loss of their parents and families as they knew them, the loss of the only person who was present of their whole life, and often the loss of a close friend. We believe this is why it is essential to begin forming an all-island bereavement support for adult siblings facing all kinds of sibling loss. We hope you can join us in this effort by sharing about this Bereavement Information Evening with your community.

Bereaved parents and adult bereaved siblings are warmly invited to register here:
[Register here for Anam Cara Online Bereavement Information Evening](#)